

published by a website is known as an RSS feed or a news feed or a web feed. Like a web page, an RSS feed will be accessible from a World Wide Web address.

<http://www.vsubhash.in/rss.xml>
<http://rss.cnn.com/rss/edition.rss>

A website can have multiple news feeds.

<http://www.vsubhash.in/blogs/blog/rss.xml>
<http://www.vsubhash.in/blogs/tweets/rss.xml>

Some websites provide topic-specific RSS feeds.

<https://news.google.com/rss/search?q=ukraine>
<https://stackoverflow.com/feeds/tag?tagnames=java>

A website may provide reader comments in a thread-specific RSS feed.

<https://www.opensourceforu.com/2016/05/how-to-run-android-without-google/feed/>
<https://stackoverflow.com/feeds/question/77349789>

Real-time data can be published as RSS feeds.

<https://rssfeed.azure.status.microsoft.com/en-us/status/feed/>
https://w1.weather.gov/xml/current_obs/PAMR.rss

RSS clients

End users who wish to read or be notified of the fresh content using these RSS links will have to use RSS client applications. RSS clients are variously known as RSS readers, news readers, or feed readers. RSS readers are available as desktop and mobile applications. Browsers and email clients may natively support RSS feed or with add-ons. There are some online RSS reader services but they defeat the idea of using RSS for anonymity.

When you encounter a site that you like, find out its RSS link. It is usually behind an orange icon as shown in Figure 1. Some news websites may have a dedicated page where they list all their RSS links.



Figure 1: RSS feeds are advertised using this easily identifiable icon

An undeclared war on RSS?

Facebook and Twitter used to have RSS feeds when they were growing their audience. To monetise their apps, they removed RSS support and became walled gardens. There

was also an undeclared war on RSS (<https://www.smh.com.au/technology/apple-joins-the-war-on-rss-20120731-23d8y.html>). Web browsers used to indicate the availability of an RSS feed in the address bar, but they quietly removed the feature. If Google, Facebook and Twitter can become the gateways of online content, it becomes easier to censor news, opinion and information.

Does YouTube have RSS feeds?

Strangely, YouTube video channels continue to support RSS. They do not display the links anywhere. You have to manually construct it in this format:

https://www.youtube.com/feeds/videos.xml?channel_id=_____

The blank part must be replaced with the internal channel ID of whichever video you are watching. Now that YouTube has assigned Twitter-like user names to channels, the channel IDs are not easy to copy. However, you can open the web console (*Tools » Web Developer Tools » Console*) and type 'ytInitialPlayerResponse.videoDetails.channelId'; you will get the channel ID in quotation marks. For the *Electronics For You* video channel, I got the ID as "UCJbnMYV_yigckub3RjtXD1Q". With this ID, the channel RSS link can be constructed as:

https://www.youtube.com/feeds/videos.xml?channel_id=UCJbnMYV_yigckub3RjtXD1Q

To automate this task for other channels, create a bookmarklet in your browser with this code:

```
window.alert("https://www.youtube.com/feeds/videos.xml?channel_id=" + ytInitialPlayerResponse.videoDetails.channelId);
```

What is a bookmarklet? It is a bookmark that uses JavaScript code instead of an ordinary WWW address. The code has to be specially formatted for use in a bookmark. There are a lot of bookmarklet formatter website services that you can use for this purpose.

Use RSS for profit

A major problem with many web design and marketing professionals is that they know all about social media and nothing about RSS. When they are asked to improve the reach of an existing website, the first thing they do is remove support for RSS feeds. Their reasoning is that RSS readers allow people to stay inside their RSS readers and never visit the site publishing the content. This is a misconception. A website needs to publish only the article headlines in its RSS feed. It does not have to publish the entire article content in